# Kanban Board Design

Design a board that shows how work really flows: columns, WIP limits, exit policies and classes of service.

Manage Flow · Visualise the Workflow · Limit WIP · Make Policies Explicit

TEAM _____

DATE _____

## 1 Workflow Columns

LEFT TO RIGHT · ONE COLUMN PER REAL STATE OR QUEUE

**COLUMN 1** *e.g. Options*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

**COLUMN 2** *e.g. Ready*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

**COLUMN 3** *e.g. Building*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

**COLUMN 4** *e.g. Waiting for review*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

**COLUMN 5** *e.g. Testing*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

**COLUMN 6** *e.g. Ready to release*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

**COLUMN 7** *Done*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

**Done when (exit policy):**

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

## 2 Classes of Service

HOW WE TREAT DIFFERENT KINDS OF WORK

| CLASS | WHEN TO USE IT | OUR POLICY | LIMIT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Expedite** | *Urgent, high cost of delay now* | | |
| **Fixed date** | *Value drops after a date* | | |
| **Standard** | *Most work, in priority order* | | |
| **Intangible** | *Improvement, tech debt* | | |

## 3 Board Policies

WRITE THEM ON THE BOARD

We pull work when: _____

Blocked items are marked by: _____

Replenishment: when & who: _____

We walk the board at: _____

Definition of Done lives at: _____

Policies reviewed every: _____

## 4 Cards & Swimlanes

**Each card shows:**

☐ Title ☐ Owner ☐ Age (days)

☐ Blocked flag ☐ Class of service ☐ Due date

Swimlanes (if any): _____

## 5 Flow Metrics to Watch

LEARN, DON'T JUDGE

☐ WIP *items in progress*

☐ Cycle time *start to done, in days*

☐ Blocked time *days items spend blocked*

☐ Throughput *items done per week*

☐ Work item age *how long open items have run*

☐ Flow efficiency *active time / total time*

*"Where does work wait, and is that visible on our board?"*

*"What would happen if we lowered this WIP limit by one?"*

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